

Topic: **Life and Importance of Holy Prophet (PBUH): Life in Madinah.**

Sub Topic: **9th Year of Hijrah: Expedition of Tabuk.**

Q (a) Write an account of main events of Tabuk Expedition. [10]

Structure of Answer

- Strained relationship between Muslims and Byzantine after Battle of Mau'tah.
 - Defeat at Mau'tah dented Romans' authority and paved way for a possible uprising in Arab areas that were occupied and ruled by Byzantines. Heraclius, the Roman Emperor was waiting for a right time to strike back on Muslims to gain his lost prestige.
 - Famous Muslim historian Al-Tibrani writes that Byzantines received an anonymous letter from Arab mentioning:
📖 "Muhammad has died and Arabs are dying of drought and hunger, there will never be a better chance to attack Madinah and finish Islam."
 - Emperor Heraclius ordered to prepare an army and he got ready to launch a massive and disastrous attack on Madinah. Ghassan who were the rulers of Syria appointed by Heraclius, managed to prepare an army of 40 thousand warriors including soldiers of Jizaam and Lakhm.
 - A Syrian tribe would visit Madinah to sell olive oil; they leaked the news of Roman preparations to attack Madinah. Prophet (PBUH) realized the need of hour and called Muslims for Jihad.
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- Hot weather of September and drought.
 - Hypocrites scaring Muslims not to take part in this expedition as Roman Army is so dangerous and their farms would be destroyed in their absence.
 - Generous donations were made by Muslims:
As Abu Bakr (RA) submitted his all belongings which were equal to 4 thousand dirham.
📖 The Prophet said, "O Abu Bakr! What did you leave to your family?" He said, "I left God and His Messenger to them."
Half belongings by Umar bin al-Khattab (RA), 200 Auqiah Silver by Abdul Rahman bin Auf (RA), 300 camels with accessories and 1000 dinar by Uthman bin Affan (RA).
 - Reaching Tabuk and getting to know that Roman army had already dispersed. Prophet (PBUH) came back Madinah after 20 days stay and some establishing some strategic treaties and alliances.
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- Tabuk was the last expedition attended by Holy Prophet (PBUH). It was one of the most important expeditions of his life.
 - The way Roman Army dispersed before the arrival of Muslim army it had a great impact on different tribes of Arab. As they realized the strength of Muslims and entered into alliance with Muslims.
 - Muslims gained serious political benefits from this expedition. Chief of Ailah named Yahnah and leaders of Azruh and Jarba' approached Holy Prophet (PBUH) and pledged their allegiance to Muslims and agreed to give Jizyah. These alliances set grounds for Muslims to expand their power inside and outside of Arab.
 - Upon coming back from Tabuk, in response to Hypocrites open aggression against Islam, Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) demolished the Masjid e Ziraar which was built by hypocrites and they used to gather there for planning and plotting the conspiracies against Prophet (PBUH) and Muslims.



📖 “And those [hypocrites] who took for themselves a mosque for causing harm and disbelief and division among the believers...” [09:107]

- Abdullah bin Ubayy the Chief of Hypocrites also died after some days of Tabuk.

Q (b) Explain the significance of Expedition of Tabuk. [04]

Points to be covered

- This was the last expedition of Holy Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) as He did not participate in any other expedition after Tabuk.
- This was the first time that a super power and the biggest empire tried to engage Muslims directly. This was a test of Muslims' courage in which they proved themselves to be really good at it.
- Despite financial crisis, drought and propaganda campaign of Hypocrites, Muslims responded to call of Prophet (PBUH) and helped Him succeed in one the biggest test of His life. This strengthened the relationship between Prophet (PBUH) and His companions and left a legacy for upcoming generations of Muslims.
- Despite being a disastrous and unchallengeable force, Byzantines could not face Muslims and dispersed before arrival of Muslims army. This dented their influence and uplifted morale of Muslims and proved them to be the next super power.
- Most importantly, aggressive march of Muslims and Roman dispersal made many leaders from different border tribes/towns to pledge their support to Islam and be the supporter of Islamic empire. This strengthened Islamic empire and set the grounds for their upcoming conquests.

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